



MONTHLY UPDATE

Benin: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-28 · 29 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA

Summary of the month

Three instruments were issued in the eight days to 31 July. On 24 July a joint circular required every state structure to [digitise its paper records](#), stating printing, archiving and carbon costs as the returns. On 28 July the digital agency published the [conditions of access](#) to the national data exchange, which include authorisation by the data-protection authority before a private body may first connect. On 31 July the same agency opened drafting of a [national DPI roadmap](#), whose stated aim is that the state stop asking citizens for documents it issued itself.

On 16 July the identity agency's director general stated the birth-registration gap: [about 2.5m births declared between 2021 and 2025 against under 1m registered](#). A single-window pilot at ten maternities [raised registration to 76.56%](#); its wider rollout has slipped.

A full read of the state's estimates volumes, dated 25 July, establishes that the data-protection authority carries its own budget line across three years while the digital agency that runs the CSIRT, the data centre and the PKI has no visible line in any of them.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The Cotonou cyber-hub programme now carries four parts: hosting the continental cyber forum, [a cybersecurity-only incubator at Abomey-Calavi](#), a statewide risk-management framework with a crisis exercise for state information-security officers, and [300 police unit heads trained during 2026](#).

Regional collaboration

The customs administrations of Nigeria, Cameroon and Benin [adopted a joint communiqué on 27 July establishing a trilateral steering committee](#) to apply a southern African border-modernisation model to the Sèmè-Kraké and Mfum-Ekok corridors, after a benchmarking mission whose technical team included two named private suppliers alongside the three administrations. Separately, the cross-border digital identity work Benin does through Smart Africa moved from development into a running pilot: [an identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two](#), with eighteen further countries said to be joining and no date given for any of them.

Standards

Interoperability gained its rules and its gatekeeper in the same month. The [conditions of access to the national exchange were published on 28 July](#): registration in the interoperable-solutions catalogue, demonstrated data governance, compatible infrastructure, and a convention per exchange naming data, purposes, responsibilities and security measures — and, for a private body, an adhesion convention plus data-protection authority authorisation before first connection. That places the authority inside the technical onboarding path rather than at the end of it as a complaint channel. No fee schedule, processing time or count of authorised participants is stated. The [national root certification authority and trust services are operating](#), and architecture and application-integration referentials went out to consultation on the same date, intended to end siloed platform-building.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Benin is [ranked fourth in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment](#) — a reference ranking, cited here and not absorbed into the ledger as a position of the state's own.

Finance

New investments

One commitment entered the window. During a ministerial visit of 4 to 6 August, Canada [announced CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa](#). The remaining six lines are outside the digital estate. What the digital line does not carry is an implementing partner, a start date or a duration, so there is nothing yet to follow from the announcement to a system.

ICT Infrastructure

Cybersecurity

The month's one figure for how exposed the country is came from a vendor rather than the state. In a national newspaper interview the head of the computer emergency response body [cited 631 ransomware threats detected in Benin in 2024, on security-vendor telemetry reported through Interpol's Africa assessment](#), attributing the rise to fast adoption outrunning security practice and to a criminal market where access and tooling can be rented rather than built. How much of the national estate that vendor sees is unpublished, so the count is not a measure of national exposure, and no incident, ransom-payment or recovery figure stands beside it.

DPI

Data Exchange

The exchange [recorded more than 138 million requests in total](#), 32.7m in the preceding thirty days, across 73 members, 176 information systems and 512 services.

A second kind of data exchange entered the record in August, and it is regional rather than national. The BIC-UEMOA credit information bureau held its first Cotonou data forum on 23 July, [reported on 13 August](#), with the finance ministry framing data quality as the route to cutting credit-approval turnaround to 48 hours. The bureau spans all eight union states with 321 data providers, about 48 million contracts and more than 20 million active borrowers. The figures are the operator's own and union-wide; nothing Benin-specific — coverage, dispute rate or the data-protection basis for the file — is held.

Registries

On 16 July the identity agency's director general set out the birth-registration gap and the single-window remedy at ten maternities.

Sectoral management information systems

The tax directorate's information-system modernisation surfaced in the window only because its funder republished the project sheet. The EUR 2m project [runs from 9 August 2023 to 31 December 2026](#), which puts it four months from its stated end. What the sheet does not carry is any statement of what has been delivered — no module, no milestone, no completion status — so the base can date the project and price it, and cannot say whether it is finishing or merely ending.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The [justice sector's 2026–2033 plan](#) commits to a case-tracking portal, secure hosting of judicial instruments and digitally integrated legal aid. It names no budget, no sequencing and no implementing agency.

Technology

AI

A [four-country comparative study presented on 10 August found no AI-specific legislation in force or in draft in Benin](#), which leaves the 2023–2027 national strategy carrying the field on its own. The same study rates Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance, and finds Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one of the four to name AI-based processing explicitly.

ICT Industry

A domestic content-verification platform founded in 2025 was profiled on 27 July; it checks text, images, audio and video, including AI-generated content.

Capacity

Literacy

A co-author of the national artificial-intelligence strategy [published a build-an-LLM-from-scratch book arguing for frugal domestic artificial intelligence](#), its sharpest claim being a scarcity of graphics processors turning artificial intelligence into a luxury good.

Training and skills

The [first national artificial-intelligence olympiad was held on 9 July](#). No entry numbers, institutions or results are published.

Data

National statistics

The digital agency published these exchange-usage figures on 11 July.

Open data

The Open Government Partnership national action plan's co-creation opened at the end of the month, eighteen months after the country joined. Nothing moved this month on data protection or the digital-strategy stack.

Benin is [preparing its first Open Government Partnership national action plan](#), built around four axes of which two are budget transparency and accountability, and access to information and digital governance. No draft, consultation calendar or submission date is on file.

The roadmap itself arrived a fortnight later. The budget directorate published a [38-activity co-creation matrix](#) naming for each step the responsible body, its partners, the funding source and an indicative deadline, running from the June 2025 ministerial order that established the national committee through preparation, departmental consultation and adoption to documentation of the process after December 2026, with activity 32 committing government to publish a what-was-heard, what-was-kept-and-why report alongside a matrix of reasoned responses. The plan itself is not adopted, and no consultation record or commitment text is published.

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